JAMES CALDWELL

London, United Kingdom

james.caldwell@gmail.com

+44 7911 582341

linkedin.com/in/jamescaldwell92

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Forward Deployed Engineer with 12 years building and supporting infrastructure at customer sites and remote locations. Skilled at troubleshooting complex distributed systems under pressure, training on-site teams, and bridging the gap between engineering and customer operations. Based in London, I've worked across Europe and Asia managing critical deployments that required both technical depth and strong communication skills.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Cloud Infrastructure: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Containerization: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Compose

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Networking: TCP/IP, VPN, BGP, DNS, Load Balancing

Scripting: Python, Bash, Go

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, Debian), Windows Server

Version Control: Git, GitLab, GitHub

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Forward Deployed Engineer

Vertex Systems

vertex-systems.io

London, UK

March 2021 - Present

Deployed and maintained Kubernetes clusters across 8 customer sites in Europe and Middle East, ensuring 99.9% uptime for mission-critical applications serving financial institutions with 24/7 on-call support.

Designed and implemented monitoring infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana for 15+ customer environments, reducing mean time to detection for infrastructure issues from 4 hours to 22 minutes on average.

Trained customer operations teams on infrastructure management and incident response procedures, developing comprehensive documentation and runbooks that reduced dependency on vendor support by 60%.

Architected a standardized deployment pipeline using Terraform and Ansible that reduced new site onboarding time from 6 weeks to 2 weeks and decreased deployment errors by 75%.

Senior Forward Deployed Engineer

Nexus Networks

nexus-networks.co

Amsterdam, Netherlands

August 2017 - February 2021

Managed on-site infrastructure implementations for 12 enterprise clients across Central Europe, serving as primary technical contact for production environments running distributed transaction processing systems with sub-millisecond latency requirements.

Developed Python-based automation tools for network configuration and health checking that reduced manual operational overhead by 40% and enabled smaller teams to manage larger deployments.

Responded to critical production incidents with 99.2% resolution rate within SLA windows, including complex multi-layer networking issues and database replication failures that required deep root cause analysis.

Established knowledge transfer program working alongside customer engineering teams to build internal capability, resulting in 8 customers achieving Level 3 self-service operational maturity within 18 months.

Forward Deployed Engineer

Catalyst Infrastructure

catalyst-infrastructure.net

London, UK

July 2012 - July 2017

Deployed and commissioned distributed storage systems across 20+ customer data centers in UK and Europe, managing hardware provisioning, network configuration, and initial data migration for systems handling up to 500TB per site.

Provided first and second line technical support for production infrastructure issues, with average resolution time of 2.3 hours and 94% customer satisfaction rating across all support engagements.

Authored detailed deployment documentation and standard operating procedures for each customer installation, improving consistency and enabling knowledge retention as customer teams cycled through personnel.

Mentored 4 junior engineers in deployment methodologies and troubleshooting approaches, with 3 subsequently promoted to senior roles within the organization.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

2008 - 2012

ADDITIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)

Linux Foundation

2020

AWS Solutions Architect Professional

Amazon Web Services

2019

Certified Jenkins Engineer

CloudBees University

2018